■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, October 02, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Dodgers reveal surprising mindset behind World Series three-peat quest*

The Angle: *No team has won three straight World Series since the late-90s Yankees dynasty, and the Dodgers think the key to history is staying almost weirdly low-key about it — a great 'can a chip-on-the-shoulder team stay humble' debate for the hosts.*

- The **Dodgers** are chasing a **World Series three-peat** — something no team has done in decades.
- Per the report, the club's approach heading into the quest is described as **'surprisingly simple'**.
- A three-peat would put this **Dodgers** core in rare company among modern dynasties.

The Debate Starter

- Does a 'keep it simple' mindset actually win championships, or is that just what winners say after the fact?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/02/sports/dodgers-reveal-surprising-mindset-behind-world-series-three-peat-quest/

■ *New Cornell study: Trump has taken more control of federal spending than any president in modern history by freezing funds Congress approved and imposing tariffs on his own, yet Congress whose job it is to control the money, has done almost nothing to stop it, even though most Americans oppose this.*

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Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/ps-political-science-and-politics/article/abs/not-with-a-bang-but-a-whimper-congressional-silence-amid-an-historic-assault-on-the-power-of-the-purse/A11F99D8476AD4CE0199CC4797406CB4

■ *Trump becomes only object on Earth exempt from Canadian urge to apologize*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate Canadian stereotype turned inside out — the most famously polite people on Earth, who'll say sorry for bumping into a parked car, suddenly draw a hard line when it comes to Trump. It's a fun proxy for how fed up Canadians are with him right now.*

- **r/Canada** is running with the joke that **Trump** is the one exception to the national habit of over-apologizing
- The bit plays on the classic **"sorry" stereotype** Canadians are known for worldwide
- It's landing amid ongoing **US-Canada friction** that's made Trump a lightning rod north of the border

The Debate Starter

- What's the one thing you refuse to apologize for, no matter how Canadian you are?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/10/trump-becomes-only-object-on-earth-exempt-from-canadian-urge-to-apologize/

■ *Woman in fake nurse case once again avoids sentencing after 6th postponement*

The Angle: *Woman in fake nurse case once again avoids sentencing after 6th postponement*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/newfoundland-labrador/lisa-driscoll-strickland-fake-nurse-9.7366837?cmp=rss

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■ *Northwestern routs Penn State in first game at Wildcats' new stadium*

The Angle: *Northwestern routs Penn State in first game at Wildcats' new stadium*

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/03/sports/penn-state-routed-by-northwestern-in-first-game-at-wildcats-new-stadium/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Michael J. Fox promoted to companion level of Order of Canada*

The Angle: *Michael J. Fox promoted to companion level of Order of Canada*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://toronto.citynews.ca/2026/10/02/michael-j-fox-to-be-promoted-within-order-of-canada-at-rideau-hall-today/

■ *Stephen Harper warns Alberta separatism will bring 'no benefit'*

The Angle: *Alberta separatist talk has been bubbling up again, and now a former Prime Minister is wading in directly to shut it down - that's a big name lending weight to a fight that's usually dismissed as fringe noise.*

- Former PM **Stephen Harper** is publicly warning that Alberta separatism would bring **"no benefit"** to the province

The Debate Starter

- Is "Wexit" ever a real threat, or is this just Alberta venting at Ottawa again?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/stephen-harper-alberta-separatism-9.7367419

■■ *Christa Pike on ventilator after surviving Tennessee execution attempt, lawyer says*

The Angle: *A botched lethal injection is about as rare and unsettling as death penalty news gets, and it's reigniting the debate over capital punishment right as Canada's total ban makes for an easy contrast on air.*

- **Christa Pike** was convicted of killing a classmate back in **1995**, when she was just **18**.
- Tennessee tried to execute her by **lethal injection** earlier this week — and the attempt failed.
- Her attorneys say she's now on a **ventilator**, receiving breathing assistance.
- Pike has been on death row for roughly **three decades** since her conviction.

The Debate Starter

- Does a failed execution change how people feel about the death penalty — or does it just make a bad system look worse?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/christa-pike-ventilator-tennessee-execution-9.7367500?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *G7 nations agree to release 100 million barrels of oil, including diesel, amid energy crunch*

The Angle: *Gas and diesel prices hit everyone's wallet, and the G7's coordinated release signals just how tight the energy crunch has gotten heading into colder months.*

- **G7 nations** agreed to release **100 million barrels** of oil from reserves
- The release includes **diesel**, not just crude
- Move comes amid a broader **energy crunch** squeezing supply

The Wallet Check

- Have you noticed gas or heating costs creeping up this fall - is this actually going to move the needle for you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/g7-trump-diesel-reserve-release-9.7366871?cmp=rss

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■ *Backstreet Boys coming to Toronto for four shows at Rogers Centre in February*

The Angle: *A 90s/2000s boy band legend is landing a multi-night Toronto residency, and that kind of nostalgia tour always gets the group chats and phone lines lit up.*

- **Backstreet Boys** are booked for **four shows** at **Rogers Centre** in Toronto
- The run is set for **February**
- Multiple back-to-back dates at a stadium-sized venue signals serious demand for the reunion/nostalgia tour circuit

The Nostalgia Trigger

- Which boy band from your teenage years would you still pay full price to see live?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiuAFBVV95cUxOb1d3V2N6SzVEa3d3TngzNjZpU3VwTmxlQlZyX1pZZGVOLVlqbmhzVWVsNWdjcVQzTC1Ndk56dnlkUjloNms0c25sbnhrdGJueUc3bVRaQ1VrdVBmWXdLLTJGUlhpbEVZY1dkVkdWM1FseXNwQ3hwTUlqa2NZNkpHb2VJbU5DS3BFeGJucUUxOWloZC1EaWpNcS1CMEFHVnFJRGs2VW5TSG1KS2dQTDBnbWFHOU1HTTRf?oc=5

■ *His bank says he opened a $35K line of credit and was issued a card at a Milton branch. But he's never been there.*

The Angle: *This is the kind of identity-fraud story that makes everyone nervously check their own bank app - a stranger's walking around with a card and $35,000 of credit tied to this guy's name, and the bank somehow didn't catch it.*

- A **$35,000 line of credit** was opened under his name without his knowledge.
- The bank issued a **physical card** tied to the account.
- Both the credit line and card trace back to a **Milton, Ontario branch** he says he's **never visited**.
- He's now left trying to get his own bank to explain how this slipped through.

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have you ever caught fraud on your account before the bank did - call in and tell us how you found out.

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMi-AFBVV95cUxPMnBJWkJEZXV3XzI5MDlEWUZqVURkMEl3cU5lczJkWE1xaXMzSy1UQWU2bHZpaXV6S184Vno0bEdGZUJKQXBVUmRaM0pCeUJ4cmhSME1jSTlocjE4RTRES0M5OHpYbEd6ZmphSU1QRHI1N2cwZDFwSXlVelVbGRPSVNFTFY4cU9kaFNqbTluOGg2a2NWVDI0ZXJ1WUtILXpNbXM1enpaelNNUnBSQ1E2bUNXbWJ5LVBVckYxNVFDYjZBS3prcGFhck4tc3ctdm04RkhWNTlJSGp0TmJ5b1E4T2Q5d2dfNThFUkF1dW9IcFMxWWtPMTZTbQ?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Michael Douglas finally admits secret relationship with 'Romancing the Stone' co-star Kathleen Turner — after 40-year denial*

The Angle: *Two Hollywood legends just blew up a 40-year denial — if two co-stars can keep a secret THAT long, the question is why, and what else is out there we don't know about.*

- **Michael Douglas** has reportedly admitted to a secret relationship with **Kathleen Turner**, his co-star from **Romancing the Stone**.
- The two had denied any romance for roughly **40 years**.
- **Romancing the Stone** (1984) is the film that made them a legendary on-screen duo.

The Debate Starter

- Forty years of denying it — would you ever believe a celebrity's 'we're just friends' again?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/02/entertainment/michael-douglas-finally-comes-clean-about-secret-relationship-with-kathleen-turner/

■■ *Christian Brothers Auto wins Jewish franchise discrimination case*

The Angle: *The irony write itself: a chain literally named 'Christian Brothers' was accused of religious discrimination against a Jewish franchisee - and won. Classic too-good-to-be-true headline that's tailor-made for a quick laugh on air.*

- **Christian Brothers Automotive**, the national auto repair franchise, was hit with a discrimination claim from a **Jewish** franchisee.
- The company came out on top, **winning** the case.

The Headline Irony

- Be honest - did the name alone make you assume how this one would go?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.chron.com/news/houston-texas/article/christian-brothers-auto-jewish-franchise-22459588.php

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■ *Digger is poised to be one of the biggest box-office flops of the year*

The Angle: *A major star's dramatic comeback plus an Oscar-winning director couldn't save this one from bombing — and when a movie gets "moon landing" levels of hype and still craters, that's a juicy Hollywood trainwreck listeners love to dissect.*

- Film stars a **major actor** making a return to **dramatic acting**
- Directed by a **two-time Best Director Oscar winner**
- Got marketing push described as rivaling **the moon landing**
- On track to be one of the **biggest box-office flops of the year**

The Debate Starter

- What's the last movie you saw hyped to the moon that completely bombed?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/digger-flop-9.7367864?cmp=rss

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■ *Zach Bryan wears ‘Free Palestine’ shirt during concert at Robert Kraft’s Gillette Stadium — after Macklemore controversy*

The Angle: *This lands exactly one month after Robert Kraft banned Macklemore from Gillette for an anti-Israel rant — so Bryan pulling this move on Kraft's own turf feels like a direct dare, and it's reopening the whole 'should musicians get political on stage' fight.*

- **Zach Bryan** wore a **"Free Palestine"** shirt during his **Friday night** concert at **Gillette Stadium**.
- Gillette Stadium is owned by **Robert Kraft**, the **Jewish NFL** owner of the **New England Patriots**.
- Just **one month earlier**, Kraft **barred Macklemore** from the venue over his **anti-Israel rant**.
- The timing and location make Bryan's shirt read as a direct follow-up to the Macklemore fallout.

The Debate Starter

- Is this Zach Bryan standing on principle, or just trolling Robert Kraft on his own field?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/03/celebrity-news/zach-bryan-wears-free-palestine-shirt-during-concert-at-robert-krafts-gillette-stadium-after-macklemore-controversy/

Backup options:

■ *Going streaming route for tight ends is play right now in fantasy football*

The Angle: *Fantasy football managers are hitting the same wall they hit every single year: tight end is a black hole, and the smart move is stop committing to one and start streaming matchups week to week.*

The Debate Starter

- Who's on the phone defending their one "elite" tight end instead of admitting it's time to stream the position?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/03/betting/going-streaming-route-for-tight-ends-is-play-right-now-in-fantasy-football/

■ *"Good Heavens": Kathleen Turner Reacts to Michael Douglas' Bombshell About Their Secret Romance During 'Romancing the Stone'*

The Angle: *Michael Douglas drops a bombshell in his new memoir that he and Kathleen Turner secretly hooked up during 'Romancing the Stone' - and her reaction is pure chaotic-icon energy. It's a 40-year-old Hollywood secret blowing up in real time.*

- **Michael Douglas** reveals the affair in excerpts from his new memoir, **'One Helluva Ride'**
- The romance happened on set of **'Romancing the Stone'** (1984)
- **Kathleen Turner's** reaction to the reveal: **"Good Heavens"**
- The two went on to become one of Hollywood's most beloved on-screen pairs, starring together in multiple films after this

The Debate Starter

- Would you want your decades-old secret romance revealed in your co-star's memoir - or is some chemistry better left off the page?

www.hollywoodreporter.com (Tier 3) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 4 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-news/kathleen-turner-michael-douglas-secret-romance-romancing-stone-1236721432/

■ *Kathleen Turner responds to Michael Douglas revealing their secret affair during 'Romancing the Stone' - ew.com*

The Angle: *Decades after lighting up the screen together in 'Romancing the Stone,' Michael Douglas just spilled that there was a real-life secret affair with co-star Kathleen Turner - and now she's clapping back with her own response, which is exactly the kind of old-Hollywood gossip that writes itself.*

- **Michael Douglas** revealed there was a secret affair with **Kathleen Turner** during the filming of **'Romancing the Stone'**
- **Kathleen Turner** has now publicly responded to Douglas's revelation
- The pair are longtime on-screen partners, having starred together in multiple films beyond 'Romancing the Stone'

The Debate Starter

- Co-star chemistry on screen or something more - where's the line, and should secrets like this stay buried?

Entertainment Weekly (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMikgFBVV95cUxQdC1lZ0xueEFzUTBLQkNWM1Z3UHRPTE9GbVJMcDBiOHpIdEF5T1JCYmx2Um9mMjhPWTdwY3BVUnVfQ1FuMmtIYmlEWXZwMDdYQ2dOb01tV2VQWTNRTEVvbm5ZNGlGeXlsVjhiQnlGRzJxYUpkOWRORDc4Zmk5SERzaGktWmNtNjRLeEFLcVpsSUtxQQ?oc=5

■ *Michael Douglas reveals secret Kathleen Turner romance after lying for 40 years - ew.com*

The Angle: *Two Hollywood legends, one buried romance, and a confession four decades in the making — this is prime watercooler gossip that fans of their classic on-screen pairings will eat up.*

- **Michael Douglas** has revealed he was secretly romantically involved with **Kathleen Turner**.
- He reportedly kept the relationship under wraps for **40 years** before going public with it now.

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's the longest you've kept a juicy secret from everyone — and did it ever come out?

Entertainment Weekly (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 77/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMinAFBVV95cUxOU1FIVmU5RnVwbGF0OEJteVc1dU5hWHJyQjkzb0NoX1Fnd2ZSVVhsbzEyV0F5cFk4UUlrNGx4U214OWtCaHkwSjJoQllZU3hVdWQtLVgzT3p6VXVnX285S1hsakRKNmJoUEZFbGd1eGRYVkZVMVhDWDhRaFlyUF8wdjNqNlJyVlNzbjdiMUZ2ZGZyaEFHYmFDYlpSSW0?oc=5

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Hudson Williams wore this cardigan. Then the Indigenous designer's business went viral*

The Angle: *This is the dream scenario for any small business: one celebrity wears your product once, and suddenly you're sold out and trending worldwide — and it's tied to a meaningful date, which gives it real heart.*

- **Hudson Williams**, star of **Heated Rivalry**, wore the cardigan to an event in **New York** on Wednesday
- The piece is a blue-and-black **"journey knit" cardigan** designed by **Justin Jacob Louis**, an Indigenous designer
- Williams paired it with an **orange ribbon**, marking **National Day for Truth and Reconciliation**
- The moment sent the designer's small business viral

The Viral Fashion Moment

- One celebrity, one outfit, one social post — that's all it takes now to make or break a small business overnight.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/hudson-williams-sweater-by-canadian-indigenous-designer-9.7367645?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *'Kingdom Come Deliverance' Studio Co-Founder Expresses Hope That GTA6 Will Drive Up Game Prices*

The Angle: *The co-founder of 'Kingdom Come: Deliverance' is openly hoping GTA6's price tag pushes the whole industry's prices up — a gamer-rage lightning rod days before one of the biggest launches in gaming history.*

- The comment comes from a **co-founder of the Kingdom Come: Deliverance studio**, not from Rockstar itself.
- The hope: that **GTA6's pricing** sets a new, higher industry standard other publishers follow.
- Gamers online have reportedly reacted... let's just say **not calmly** — the backlash has been swift and loud.

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually pay more for games if it meant studios could pay workers better — or is this just corporate spin dressed up as empathy?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/kingdom-come-deliverance-studio-co-founder-expresses-hope-that-gta6-will-drive-up-game-prices-2000821035

■ *Falcon Heavy to fly its first mission for U.S. spy satellite agency - Spaceflight Now*

The Angle: *Falcon Heavy just flew its first-ever mission for America's spy satellite agency — a reminder that the guy who makes memes also quietly launches national security hardware into orbit.*

- **SpaceX** launched the **NROL-97** mission on **Oct. 1, 2026**
- The payload flew for the **National Reconnaissance Office** — the U.S. government's spy satellite agency
- It's the **first NRO payload** ever to fly on a **Falcon Heavy** rocket

The Watercooler Angle

- We don't even know what's actually on that rocket — and that's kind of the point.

Spaceflight Now (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://spaceflightnow.com/2026/10/01/falcon-heavy-to-fly-its-first-mission-for-u-s-spy-satellite-agency/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Unsafe sleep factors found in nearly 75% of sudden unexpected infant deaths, CDC says*

The Angle: *New CDC numbers show almost 3 out of 4 sudden infant deaths involved something preventable in how the baby was sleeping — a stat that hits home for every new parent, grandparent, or sleep-deprived friend in the audience.*

- **CDC** analysis finds unsafe sleep factors present in **nearly 75%** of sudden unexpected infant deaths (SUID).
- Unsafe sleep factors typically mean things like soft bedding, loose blankets, or a baby sleeping on their stomach/side instead of flat on their back.
- SUID is an umbrella term that includes SIDS and remains one of the leading causes of death for babies under age 1.

The New-Parent Gut Check

- Parents, be honest: did anyone actually walk you through safe-sleep rules, or did you just figure it out from late-night Googling?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://edition.cnn.com/2026/10/01/health/sudden-unexpected-infant-death-safe-sleep-wellness

Backup options:

■ *Vaccines not only directly protect vaccinated individuals but also contribute to protecting the entire population via indirect herd-immunity benefits. Half of averted COVID-19 infections and 1/4 of hospitalizations and deaths were attributable to indirect protection of unvaccinated by vaccinated.*

The Angle: *New research puts hard numbers on something people argue about constantly: how much does my personal vaccine choice actually affect everyone else? Turns out, a lot - which makes this a perfect flashpoint for the ongoing personal-freedom-vs-community-health debate.*

- Researchers found **half** of all COVID-19 infections prevented by vaccines were due to **indirect herd-immunity protection** - not just the shot working on the person who got it.
- **1 in 4** avoided hospitalizations and deaths came from vaccinated people shielding **unvaccinated** people around them, not direct personal immunity.
- The takeaway: getting vaccinated isn't just a personal health decision - it's doing measurable work protecting the people who didn't get the shot.

The Debate Starter

- Does finding out your vaccine protected your unvaccinated coworker change how you feel about mandates - or does 'my body, my choice' still win?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://royalsocietypublishing.org/rsif/article/23/242/20250839/483439/Quantifying-the-direct-and-indirect-impact-of

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■ *Owning a smartphone at age 12 was associated with a 103% higher risk of tying self-worth to weight, 67% higher risk of binge eating and 49% higher risk of any eating disorder symptoms by age 14, according to a study of 8,957 adolescents*

The Angle: *Every parent listening has had the 'when do I get my kid a phone' fight, and this study puts a hard number on the risk — it's a built-in debate for parents and non-parents alike.*

- Researchers tracked **8,957 adolescents** to see what happens after getting a smartphone at age **12**
- Kids with a phone at 12 had a **103% higher risk** of tying their self-worth to their weight by age 14
- Same group showed a **67% higher risk** of binge eating
- Overall, a **49% higher risk** of any eating disorder symptoms by age 14

The Phone-In Trigger

- What age did you (or will you) hand your kid their first smartphone — and does a stat like '103% higher risk' change your answer?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://jamanetwork.com/journals/jamanetworkopen/fullarticle/2854492

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *McDonald's has been using AI to decide how much you should pay for a Big Mac*

The Angle: *McDonald's reportedly using AI to set prices is exactly the kind of 'wait, WHAT' headline that gets people checking their receipts — it taps straight into the surveillance-pricing anxiety everyone already has about apps and algorithms.*

- Story trending out of **r/nottheonion** — the subreddit literally dedicated to real headlines that sound fake
- Core claim: **McDonald's** has been using **AI** to help decide **Big Mac pricing**
- Fits a bigger pattern people are already buzzing about — so-called **'surge pricing' or 'dynamic pricing'** creeping into fast food

The Debate Starter

- Would it actually bother you if an algorithm — not a human — decided your burger costs more today than yesterday?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114053-mcdonald-using-ai-decide-how-much-you-pay.html

Backup options:

■ *Six Flags tests new names for Cedar Point, including 'Six Flags of North Ohio'*

The Angle: *Six Flags bought Cedar Point and is reportedly test-driving new park names — and 'Six Flags of North Ohio' is somehow a real contender. It's the kind of corporate-rebrand clunker that writes its own jokes.*

- **Six Flags** is testing new names for the legendary **Cedar Point** amusement park
- One proposed name on the list: **'Six Flags of North Ohio'**
- Story's gaining traction on **Reddit's r/nottheonion** for how real-but-absurd it sounds

The Debate Starter

- Vote now: does 'Six Flags of North Ohio' sound like a theme park or a DMV branch?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cleveland.com/travel/2026/10/six-flags-tests-new-names-for-cedar-point-including-six-flags-of-north-ohio.html

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Trail Blazers Fire Announcer Over Insensitive Teenage Tweets*

The Angle: *A pro sports team just fired a broadcaster over tweets from his teenage years resurfacing online - it's the latest flashpoint in the "how far back is fair game" cancel-culture debate, and it's tailor-made for a quick, spicy back-and-forth.*

- The **Portland Trail Blazers** fired a broadcaster after old tweets surfaced
- The posts in question were reportedly written when he was a **teenager**
- Story's getting traction after blowing up on **r/nottheonion**

The Debate Starter

- Should something you tweeted as a teenager be allowed to end your career as an adult?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://frontofficesports.com/article/trail-blazers-fire-announcer-insensitive-teenage-tweets/

■ *The complicated nature of disentangling autism, ADHD and complex trauma | The British Journal of Psychiatry | Cambridge Core*

The Angle: *A new psychiatry journal piece digs into how autism, ADHD, and childhood trauma symptoms overlap so much that doctors can genuinely misdiagnose one for another - a real 'wait, that happened to me' moment for a lot of listeners navigating their own or their kid's diagnosis.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Were you or your kid ever diagnosed with one of these - ADHD, autism, or anxiety from trauma - only to find out later it was actually something else entirely?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/the-british-journal-of-psychiatry/article/adhd-autism-or-complex-trauma-the-complicated-nature-of-the-question/30CC4826561366615BFAEC807CDE28A7

■ *As international student numbers tumble, domestic postsecondary enrolment rebounds*

The Angle: *As international student numbers tumble, domestic postsecondary enrolment rebounds*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/business/article-international-student-numbers-domestic-postsecondary-enrolment-rebound/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)

- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in ‘Damn Yankees’ Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka’Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: ‘I can’t eat as much’" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of ‘The Life of a Showgirl,’ Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks " (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)
- "SteelSeries brings ultra-wideband wireless to gaming mice, chasing lag-free tracking" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-30)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/fauxmoi (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- www.dailymail.co.uk (fetch failed)
- NewsAPI 'top-headlines?country=us&category=entertainment' (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 3 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-03 12:34 PM